附录贰 指画略说

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中国画史大都归源于唐，为立说说家之习惯，其实国学也可以有新发明，何必以其出身的久暂来论它的好歹，但吾国的治史者，终不能改此习惯。所以方薰《山静居论画》中推指画为唐张璪所创始。朱景玄，张彦远等曾在他们画中道及璪有‘手摸绢素’的方法。（见唐朝名画录，历代名画记及宣和画谱等书。）而宋朝的画龙专家陈容亦‘脱巾濡墨，信手涂抹’，居然能‘泼墨成云，噀水成雾’（见佩文书谱，阅画记及图书实录等书）。



唐宋名家不拘泥小节，富有创作力而有大气魄，所以用手指以补笔之不足者，大约不只张陈二人，且如清之沈南频张问陶等绝不以能指画闻，彼等竟能以平生所作一二指画传世而得后世人士之人士。如唐宋画家虽有指画之作，但其作品不克传世，则吾人又何从考其究竟？明有吴序，（字季长）亦以指画闻。（事见画史汇传）

指画之盛莫如有清，而其中以高其佩为鸡群之鹤。从其佩之后者有高璇，李世倬，高□，甘十调，赵成穆，傅雯，蔡兴祖等，其中以李赵二人最为庸中的佼佼，当时与扬州的蒋璋齐名；而松江则有王锡畴，其本领几出于此三家之上。锡畴善人物，曾画观音三千尊。他如华亭王凤岗之指松，王德普之指竹，浙江杜鳌之山水，乌程柴本勤之指画，或兼一长或善熟妙，其余吴鸿谟卢点，吴希文，姚宋，王惠，吴振武，韩润，翁仁，徐来凤，何龙，杨泰基，张铎，李昌泉，孙绿，朱嵩，朱浣，瑛梦禅，萨克远，僧定志等，或骡蒙虎皮，或移花接木，其作品以‘做作’者为多，‘挥洒’者实少。

现代习指画上海有马轶群，谢公展，北平有林彦博等，全国统计，至多不过十人，并非说物少必贵，只以习者既少，鄙人是当有努力之必要而已。

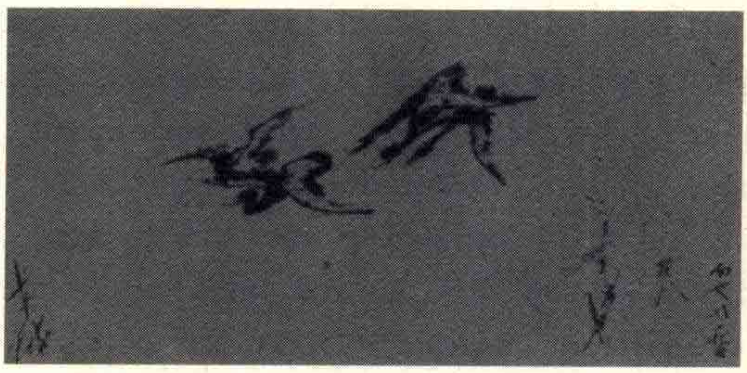




附录叁 现代中国的艺术 ART IN MODERN CHINA

By T'ENG KWEI Yenching University, Peiping

From 《the open court》, 1933.12



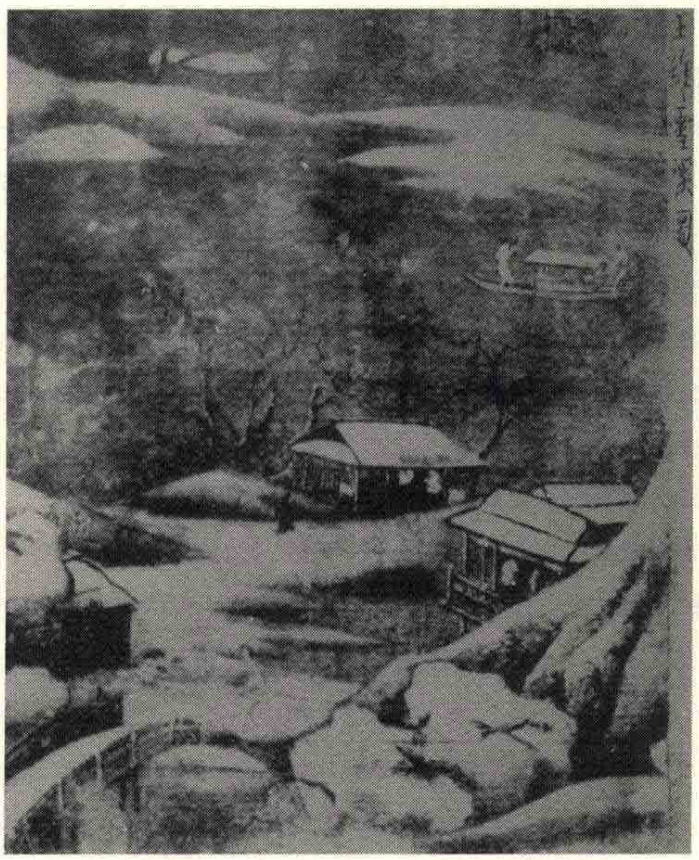
FLYING GEESE by T'ENG KWEI

CHINA at present is in a state of great turmoil—poverty stricken—military exploitation and war everywhere—war with Japan, war between war-lords. War in China, it seems, is everlasting. Unfortunate people flee from their homes to escape misery and to preserve the minimum breath of life. In such a state of bankrupty in every phase of life, how can China produce art? Yet Chinese art productions are at present incredibly abundant.

It is a mystery which cannot be explained in a few words. However, to be brief, I venture to say that the practice of art in present-day China is possible because of the victory of idealism in the life and death struggle on the part of Chinese artists. The ability to struggle seems to be a national characteristic without which they might have been extinguished long ago. Chinese artists tolerate a discouraging environment, deny

themselves much pleasure and comfort, have but little wealth, or live in poverty, spend much time earning a living, and develop their spiritual life by working out their own salvation and expressing their artistic ideals. Although China is passing through a national crisis, art exhibitions are still held in the large cities despite mass meetings, protest, and roaring of guns.

China is still producing art and in remarkable quantity. We are anxious to know what kind of art, classic or modern. If it is classic, how far ancient ideals and forces are perpetuated by



SNOW LANDSCAPE BY WANG WEI
Copied by Kung-pa King

present-day artists; if it is modern, what modern thought or what nation's modern art has influenced the hands and minds of Chinese artists. If neither modern nor classic(in the western sense of the terms), we would like to know in what manner the present art has been modified, or evolved from that of ancient times.

Let us first review the traditional philosophy of art and life of our artists. To them the reality of life lies within the mind. Nothing exists before the thought of it exists. The thought is the only reality. Through thought art is born, and through art the thought is elevated from low to high levels and from crudity to refinement. No art can be called "fine" unless there is this high thought of the artist back of the production, and hence it is capable of elevating or drawing forth thought of refinement from the spectators. Thus, life and art to our artists are both idealistic. Physical life is perishable, but art is immortal. To the Chinese artist, physical life is merely the abode of the spirit, and to enjoy an ideal life is to cultivate the spiritual one.

This art is something uncommon, something unearthly, something different from what we always see and have contact with in daily life. Genre painting has never been popular in China. The classical idea of art there has always been something which we long to see but search for in vain. Human beings are enslaved by their desires.



Only those desires which can never be obtained, Chinese artists love to paint. Kuo Hi, who lived in the eleventh century, wrote as follows about his conception of art:

> Wherein lies the reason that good men love landscape so much? It is because amid orchards and hills man has ever room to cultivate his natural trend; because streams and rocks never fail to charm the ramble who goes whistling on his way. It is because fishing and wood-gathering are natural vocations of the hermit and the recluse, nearby where flying birds and chattering apes have their homes. Noise and dust, birdles and chains—of these man's nature ever wearies. Hazes and mists, saints and fairies—for these man's nature pines eternally and pines in vain. Now comes the painter, and by his skill all these things are suddenly brought before us. In our home, stretched on the walls, we still hear the cries of the gibbons along the streams, the songs of birds in many valleys, while our eyes are flooded with the gleams of hills and the hues of falling streams. Does not this illustrate the saying, "Charmed by another's purpose, I attain my own desire"?

Like the essence of the teaching of Buddhism and Taoism, art in China is a means of escape.



LANDSCAPE BY SIAO CHIEN-CHUNG

The harder the struggle in the Chinese nation, the more unattained desires are there to be expressed through art; and the less peace in the country, the more escape Chinese artists would seek. No matter how fast modern China may change, as long as such ancient ideals are rooted in the minds of artists, there will be no danger of Chinese art being disrupted.

In order to make a survey of this traditional or classical school of Chinese art, one must wend his way to Peking which still remains Chinese, abundant in architecture, active in art craft, rich in historic relics. The people there are less affected by foreign economic exploitation. Peking, so to speak, the museum of Chinese art, has always inspired her inhabitants to cling to her own civilization. Artists there are not only able to study and copy old paintings, which are preserved

in the palaces, but there are also favorable working conditions in the way of getting special art materials and an appreciative group in society. Exhibitions of contemporary art are held there all the year round. The Central Park Galleries arrange exhibitions from March to November, and the Peking Institute of Fine Arts has one every month. The art gallery of Yenching University is also enthusiastic about patronizing present-day art.

Peking is the seat of the Traditional Conservative School. This school is interested solely in preserving old Chinese art. Most technical and scholarly work has been done by its members. They have copied painstakingly the paintings of the T'ang and Sung dynasties. They copy the strokes and the colors of the paintings; they have ever gone so far as to imitate the writing and seals of the master, and their aim has been perfection, so as to make copy and original indistinguishable even to the trained eye. The leader of this school was Kung-pa King, whose influence is still felt strongly among his followers. I have seen Kung-pa King's copy of a snow landscape by Wang Wei, famous T'ang dynasty painter. He not only used a piece of silk the exact size of the original and imitated the aged tone of the painting, but also succeeded in putting the Emperor Hui Tsung's writing there as it appears in the original.

Followers of this school are many, not only

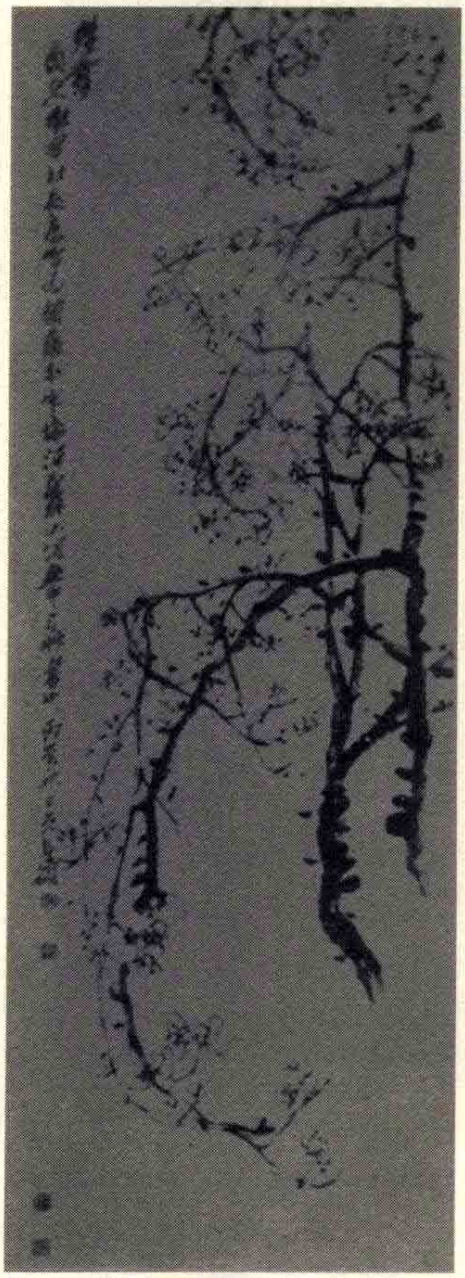


LANDSCAPE BY T'ANG TING-CHI

because China has such a glorious past that most conservative artists like to have this old sweet dream revealed to them, but also, because academically it is a popular way of learning art by copying the old masters.

Peking artists, however, belonging to this Traditional Conservative School, do not always copy old masters. Many have great creative ability like Hu P'ei-heng and Siao Chien-chung and are able to combine the traditional method of the past with an individual method of their own. An example of great individuality is the picture(page 077) by Siao. He is so sophisticated that he puts his strong statement under a veil of moderate expression. The meeker his execution, the stronger is the statement felt between the lines. The form is solid, but the appeal is harmonious, and the brush is politely exact.

There are still a great many artists who are classical enough in spirit, fine enough in ability to produce art individual enough to be called their own creation. T'ang Ting-chi is another of those artists who lay their art on a thoroughly firm and sound foundation in classical tradition. T'ang is an independent painter, adhering to no school. On account of his independence and self-respect, his fame is established through his artistic merit alone. His work speaks louder than the voices of lesser artists who collectively call for their own social prestige. The facile manner in his brush touches, his simplicity in presenting trees and rocks show the definite skill and experience of the artist's hand on this page. He does not waste a single

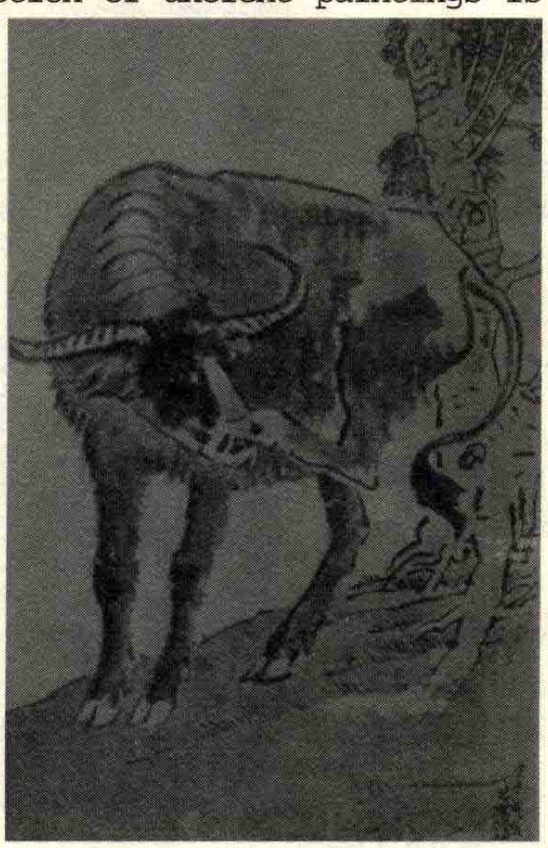


BLOSSOMING PLUM BRANCHES
BY WU T'SANG-SHU

stroke or a dot of ink; every bit of his energy is a necessity. A good artist is a miser in spending ink as he would be in spending gold, because extravagance with material is a sign of deficiency in art.

Other artists who work independently and quietly let their art speak for them. Peking should be very proud of having artists like Siao Ching-hien, Ch'en Pan-ting, and Wang Mong-pei——all with hign ideals in their work.

I now wish to introduce two prominent artists from Suchow, Ku Lin-shi and Yu Tai-ts'iu. Ku Lin-shi is a great scholar, connoisseur, and artist. His collection of ancient paintings is well known



WATER BUFFALO BY SU PEI-HUNG

in the Yangtse Valley, and his painting is often mistaken by Chinese critics as the work of the Four Wang masters of the Ts'ing dynasty. In fact, he may have produced paintings even better than some of those actually done by the Four Wang. Nature is very content under his brush, and it is quite a blessing when one has the good fortune to look at the picture here reproduced(frontispiece); comfortable trees, in-different rocks, inviting path, and rippling grass——all look most natural and most placid. His brush is at ease everywhere, and his hand is full of experience in every stroke.



LOTUS BY YÜ FEI-AN

Another school is the

Traditional Calligraphic School. By calligraphic I mean the free-hand and expression work of art. Painting and calligraphy are interrelated. A good knowledge of and experience in writing are advantageous to painting and vice versa. A painter is often a calligrapher, and a good calligrapher often learns to paint easily. Many strokes are common to calligraphy and painting. There were however, painters not known as calligraphers. They established their technique generally through the practise of painting. Their aim was to paint and to emphasize the object they painted. The medium, such as brush strokes, ink, serves only as stepping-stones through which they accomplish their objective representation; consequently the meaning, expression, and often the beauty of strokes and ink values are lost to them, while the realistic object remains. However, the painter of the calligraphic school is different from his fellow-artists. He thinks that the beauty of the ink values and the expression of brush strokes should not be sacrificed in the least for the sake of sheer realism of the subject matter. Painting is not photography, nor should it be a complete record of the facts. Those who can not appreciate the beauty of language want only the contents of a story, and those who do not know art, look only for the contents of a painting. The Traditional Calligraphic School strives, not only for the art of representation, but also for a manner of



LANDSCAPE AFTER THE RAIN BY T'ENG KWEI

presentation so that not only the end is important to them, but also the means: the expression of the medium as it is controlled, not by the hand alone, but also by the artist's interest.

The picture, "Plum Blossoms," reproduced on page 080, represents this school. The artist, Wu Ts'ang-shu, who lived in Shanghai, is a good calligrapher, drawing instead of painting the picture. His brush-strokes are strong, wiry, and brisk. The picture makes one feel great freedom of action. The brush is like the monarch, every touch is law.

To the same school I should like to add two more artists, the one being a student who returned from France, the other educated in China. The first, Sü Pei-hung, is now head of the art department at



A CHICKEN FAMILY BY T'ENG KWEI

the Central University, Nan-king. Sü has a good background in oil. His work can compete with the painters of the French Academy. However, he has preferred to paint in the Chinese style ever since his return. He has tried to subordinate western striving for likeness to the Chinese calligraphic expression. Toward this goal he has advanced successfully. It seems to me that Sü has an ideal which most of us modern Chinese artists should have; that is, to unite all Chinese art tradition with modern realistic observation and scientific approach. Sü is good at animals. He is not only correct as to anatomy, but also has powerful brush expression, and often the action and life of his animals are very expressive (page 081).

The second artist is Yü Fei-an. Living simply

and intensely, he creates a world of his own. He paints for pleasure, edits a paper, and teaches for a living. The lotus picture (page 082) is, so to speak, a symbol of his life. The lotus is a plant which has a clean stalk growing in the mud with a pure white flower, with independent and self-respecting spirit. His technique is bold and simple; he gets a maximum result with a minimum effort. His strokes are calligraphic, yet, at the same time, the anatomy is carefully observed.

Chinese artists do not consider that physical realism is the important thing to look for in art; therefore, photographic representation of nature has long been looked down upon by artists. Instead, Chinese artists go beyond the physical to metaphysics, beyond physical likeness to spiritual likeness. When Hie Ho (A.D. 475) advanced his "six canons" on painting, he placed as first and most important the rule concerning rhythmic vitality. Our artists are not satisfied in translating nature as she is, but want to explain nature as she appears to them or as they wish her to be. In China there is no such thing as "still life," and dead fish certainly do not interest our artists as they do our western colleagues, for a dead fish must be made alive in painting. Not very unlike the futurists in the west, Chinese artists paint the flight instead of the birds only; like the impressionists, Chinese artists paint the atmospheric effects of rain, mist, storm, and

sunset in the landscape, instead of the landscape as it usually appears to most eyes. I, with many others, aim at this romantic ideal of masters of the past. In the portrayal of the flight of wild geese(page 073), their speed is clearly felt and their calls can still be heard. In the picture, "After the Rain," the trees are still moist. The picture, represented on page 085, portrays a family of chickens. The father's dignity, the mother's love, the children's innocence are sought instead of showing each feather or any other anatomical detail which means labor rather than art to those who really understand painting. However, not all Chinese artists of this day strive for the same goal as I. There is a group of artists who have gained a substantial social recognition by working on something more naturalistic and even



RECUMBENT DOG BY CH'EN SE

sentimental than action, vitality, or rhythm. Their paintings are true to the facts of nature. I am taking the liberty of giving this group of artists the name "Realistic." This Realistic School has two branches, the northern and the southern; both branches were somewhat inspired by semi-foreign influence during their early stages.

Castiglione, an Italian missionary, came to China at the end of the seventeenth century and took up Chinese painting. He brought to China the scientific method of copying nature. Brilliant coloring, heavy loading of oil technique, and true-to-nature realism, which, acknowledged by all, are the chief characteristics of his painting. Many Chinese artists with high ideals as to existence and reality do not care for his work, but others appreciate it as of artistic merit, ignorant as they are of what art is. Here in Peking there has developed a school of the followers of Castiglione which I call the northern branch of the Realistic School.

Among the dozens of artists mechanically working in this realistic manner, Ch'en Se is the jade among pebbles. He is a young man in his early thirties, now teaching art at the well-known Catholic University in Peking. An example of his work, a copy of Castiglione but with lighter touches, is reproduced on page 087. The dog is very alive and ready to jump up at any moment. It is perfectly real, and this painting is a triumph

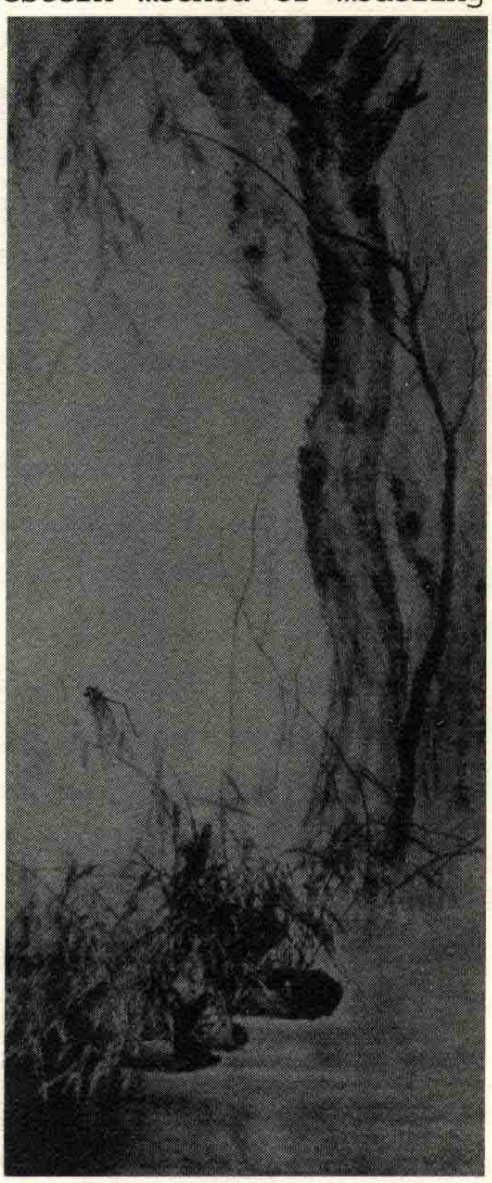
over the battle with photography.

The southern branch of the Realistic School offers a more interesting phase of our art development. Its seat is Canton, where people are comparatively more alert and active in making foreign contacts. Many artists there searched for a new expression after feeling the necessity of a change in the model of living. Many of these went to Japan to study and then transplanted to China this new style. In general, art in Japan is like anything else——a syncretism. Besides the pure, old Chinese school, Japanese art is something collected from foreign countries and made anew to suit their convenience. As a result, Japanese art in general is not calligraphic enough to appear Chinese, nor solid enough to be called western. However, like a Japanese girl, it has its own charm and beauty which can be internationally appreciated.

The popular Realistic School of Japanese art, which is natural, literary, and human, often pleasantly charming, is paradoxically of Chinese origin. In the latter part of the eighteenth century, Shen Nan-pin, a Chinese artist, visited Japan, and his art influenced the Japanese greatly. He was an animal painter and excelled in flowers and birds of the Sung academy style, realistic, honest to every feather of the bird and every petal of the flower, painstaking in execution and literary in appeal. He established the Nanking

school in Japan, and hence the Cantonese artists have brought back a bride who proved to be their forty-second cousin. However, the modern Japanese popular Realistic School is far removed from the original Nanking school. The Japanese artists, in addition to these characteristics of Shen's art, adopted much from the western method of modeling the subject in light and shadow, and thus the picture is made even closer to nature.

Kao Weng and Kao Lun, two brothers, are fine examples of the southern realistic school. This school of painting will have a strong grip on Chinese art development on account of its oriental origin and scientific rendering of the subject, which makes the art intelligible to all eyes and entertaining to most minds. Kao Weng, although a man in his seventies, is still active in



WILLOWS IN THE AUTUMN RAIN
BY KAO LU

creative work, and his paintings are full of youth and vitality. Kao Lun is the younger brother of Kao Weng. Like his brother he learns truth from nature. "Autumn Rain Comes to the Willow Bank" (page 090) shows the artist's accurate observation of the effects of rain on the landscape. The painting has a high pictorial effect; the details, as well as the composition as a whole, are properly executed.

Thus far I have set forth three different tendencies in the present state of arts in China, namely the Traditional Conservative School whose aim is to preserve China's classical art tradition; the Calligraphic School which follows the romantic school of thought, that aims at free-hand drawing and keeps the unique calligraphic expression in strokes; and the Realistic School whose interest is to adopt western ideas of light effect and scientific rendering of the anatomical correctness of the subject into Chinese art.

Productions of these schools are more or less Chinese in taste and origin, and they continue to develop. However, profuse western influence is not wanting in China today. Very little good work is seen. Chinese artists who are working in this western style incidentally learn the worst from the west. In Shanghai one can find all sorts of foreign arts ranging from the primitive to the ultramodern. When I visited Walter Pach, American critic residing in Paris, he commented on the work of a certain popular Japanese artistic as "monkey



production." By "monkey" he understood "one who tries to imitate man, but the harder the trial, the worse is the result."

Present-day China is in danger of falling into this "monkey" business. Girls from good families dance to jazz music; boys wear tailor-made suits, and Walk-over shoes, smoke Luckies, read the Saturday Evening Post, and play a good game of golf. Hu Shih advocates China's adoption of western civilization since he has much confidence in both the automobile and the Chinese people. I felt the coming of a "monkey" civilization since I have not enough confidence in either. No doubt China must pass through an industrial revolution to enable every one to live more comfortably. Art is the product of leisure, and leisure can only be accumulated through wealth. After all, no matter how idealistic the Chinese may be, one cannot expect any nation to produce art with the majority of her population almost starving. A great period of art production must be sponsored by patronage and a great demand. Art produced without sufficient wealth and leisure at its back is forced product. Neither an artificial creation nor a forced production can last forever, for they are both detached from life. To replant Chinese art on fertile soil is the duty of all our artists at present, but the question as to how the soil should be prepared is beyond the scope of this essay.

附录肆 中国墨竹 BAMBOO AND BAMBOO PAINTING

BY TENG KUEI, M.F.A., F.R.S.A.

From the royal asiatic society, north china branch (shanghai)



The history of bamboo in China dates as far back as that of the Chinese race and civilization. Its extensive usefulness in daily life well matches

its inspiring influence in intellectual circles——indeed, it is so useful and so inspiring that it has become inseparate from Chinese life. Its shoots are eaten; rafts, furniture, kitchen utensils, toys for the young and walking sticks for the old, weapons for soldiers, baskets for merchants and women, books, paper, penholders for men of letters, and instruments for musicians——all are made from bamboo. It is said that Shen Nung 神農 (? 2737 B.C.) ,the prehistoric emperor, used it as medicine. Documentary records were said to have been inscribed on bamboo tablets as early as the legendary reign of Huang Ti 黃帝 (? 2697 B.C.) —such as the law books, "the greater seal characters" of Shih Liu 史籀 (800 B.C.) ,the histographer of the Chou Dynasty. Every day and everywhere in China we are in contact with bamboo in its various forms.

Its great service in practical life so impressed the intellectual classes that they came to love it, respect it and idealize it. They have seen something beautiful and abiding beyond its material form, something quite akin to their own spirit and taste; they have attributed to it some of the ideal oirtues of man and have addressed it as a teacher, a gentleman, a friend. "I cannot get along without this gentleman(meaning bamboo) even for a single day," said Wang Wei-chih 王徽之 son of Wang His-chih 王羲之 (A.D.321-379), the father of Chinese calligraphy, whose writing about the famous



gathering of the scholars in the bamboo forest around the Orchid Pavilion is still copied by present day scholars for practical in calligraphy. The there friends in winter are the pine, the bamboo and the plum; and the four gentlemen are the plum, the orchid, the bamboo and the chrysanthemum. Every Chinese knows something about them; every poet writes about them and every artist paints them. Wang Wei's little quatrain on the bamboo reads:

"Alone I sit in the tranquil bamboo forest. Sweeping the strings and shouting long and loud; the forest is deep; no one knows my presence, but the bright moon comes to shine upon me."（獨坐幽篁裏 彈琴復長嘯 深林人不知 明月来相照）

In short, its strong, enduring nature serves as a symbol of perseverance; its perfectly straight body as a symbol of uprightness; its empty, tube-like stem a symbol of capacity and humility; its tough joints a symbol of chastity and firmness; and its wavering, rustling leaves a symbol of sweet melancholy.

Notwithstanding its importance in practical life and its influence over the intellectual, its chief inspiration lies in the world of painting, for here it not only serves as an independent subject, but also as a link between calligraphy and painting, and as the point of departure from the ancient and mediaeval, elaborate brush painting to that of the idealistic school which still flourishes in modern

times. In order to make this clear I shall briefly trace the history of Chinese painting.

Roughly speaking, Chinese painting before the T'ang Dynasty (A.D.618-905) was realistic in nature, realistic in the sense of a faithful and exhaustive registering of the facts of nature, and utilitarian in purpose. Just because it was utilitarian in purpose so it was realistic in nature. And painting was mostly by artisans (by very few real artist), though of the most marvelous order because of the strong encouragement outside and their own eagerness and sincerity in dealing with their subjects. For this reason, though great they were (as Ku K'ai-chih's roll in the British Museum for example), they lacked variety and power of stroke in genuine calligraphic sense. Consequently the beauty of the ink was not found as in later painters. In other words, the canons of calligraphic writing were not applied to painting until the coming of the T'ang masters.

The advent of the T'ang Dynasty brought with it a new school of painting, the school of idealism which reached its height in the Sung (A.D.960-1280) and Yüan Dynasty (A.D.1280-1368). The T'ang Dynasty at its height formed a period of expansion. Political and military triumphs together with societal prosperity widened views of life, encouraged hope, gave leisure to ponder over the charm and value of things as such, and aroused a zeal for initiative and adventure. The influence

of Zen (Ch'an) Buddhism as well as Taoism widened the scope of imagination. The masters, under such influences, succeeded in achieving something new by a wide and powerful fusion of both the past and the present, the objective and the subjective, the balanced and the reticent with the eccentric and the expressive.

This new idea in painting naturally called for a new way of expression, and it so happened that these masters excelled in many fields, in poetry, scholarship and especially in calligraphy, so they applied all the principles of writing to painting, and the so-called "Ink Painting" thus developed. Ink painting made possible not only variety of strokes but also gradation of ink values or shades and tone qualities.

Among all the subjects these masters painted, bamboo serves as the best illustration, for the reason that it requires the steadiest wrist, the most firm and balanced control of the brush to paint successfully its long, straight yet jointed body and its flat, knife-like leaves. In painting bamboo no painter can hide a feeble hand, a wavering brush or lazy stroke, for its peculiar nature frankly tells everything and strikingly reveals every trick. Only the most powerful masters can paint bamboo with success, and no painter can be called a master of the idealist school unless he can paint bamboo well. It is the starting point as well as the final triumph for an idealist.

Aside from these technical requirements of bamboo painting, its mastery is also an essential part in the formation of ideas which are called vision. By vision here is meant not only the concentrated visualization of the subject for the artist's particular picture, but also his own view or idealization of it and his own mood under such circumstances. In any other painting, such as a landscape or even figures, the painter may proceed with a general conception in his mind and work out its composition and the details as he goes on, but with bamboo he cannot well do this because of its previously mentioned peculiarities; otherwise there will be signs of hesitation, hints of jarring moods and wandering thoughts, and complete failure will result. Thus we may say that through bamboo painting with ink we are able to attain a better understanding of the psychological conditions under which the art is produced than in any other branch of Chinese art. We may also say that bamboo, being the chief representative of both the technical as well as the idealistic sides of this new school, represents a further step from ancient and mediaeval painting to that of modern times. For it has been the connecting link between calligraphy and painting, as well as the point of departure from mere artistic painting to that of personality and scholarly expression which may be rightly claimed as truly representative of the genius of Chinese art.

Coming to the painting of bamboo itself, a few points are to be made clear. First, who originally painted bamboo as an independent subject? Second, who first painted "ink bamboo"? Third, what are the technical secrets of ink bamboo painting? Finally, who are the masters of ink bamboo painting?

Madame Li 李夫人 of the later T'ang Dynasty is generally known as the original painter of ink bamboo. She earnestly studied the shadows of the bamboo wavering on the window screens under the moonlight. But according to the Hua Shih Hui Chuan 畫史彙傳 written by P'ên Wên-ts'an 彭蘊燦, Kuan Yü 關羽 the adopted brother of Liu Pei 刘備 Emperor of Shu Han 蜀漢(third century A.D.) was the first painter of bamboo, and his paintings were later engraved on stone tablets. Between these two painters there were many other bamboo painters such as the great T'ang masters Wu Tao-tzŭ 吳道子 and Wang Wei 王維. However, none of them painted bamboo as an independent subject. The earliest artist who thus painted it as an independent subject was Wên T'ung 文同 of the Sung Dynasty(d.1079). He was also the first to paint bamboo in ink. The masters before Wên T'ung did not paint with such definite technique as is called ink painting, They treated bamboo as they would treat any other plant, utilizing massive foliage to fill in the backgrounds of their landscapes; the features of the figures are not finely studied in their detailed exquisiteness.

Bamboo may be painted in double outline with

color or without color but so far as technique is concerned, neither of these styles is as difficult to paint as ink painting; nor do these styles show as powerful strokes and as ideal images as ink painting. The ink paintings of bamboo make use of nearly all the eight brush canons of calligraphy and the five values of ink. Unlike color painting of bamboo, which is an endeavor to attain the balance and contrast between different colors, ink painting is a triumph of writing of thought and coloring in monochrome.

Painters of ink bamboo are numerous, but a few of the greatest who may be discussed here are Wên T'ung 文同, Su Tung-P'o 蘇東坡 of the Sung Dynasty (A,D930-1278),Wu Chên 吳鎮, Fu Kuang 傅光, Ko Chiu-ssŭ 柯九思, and the wife of Chao Mêng-Fu, Kuan Chung-chi管仲姬 (1260-1333) of the Yüan Dynasty. Wang Fu,王紱 (1362-1416) ,Wên Chêng-ming 文徵明, Madame Ma Hsiang-Lan 馬湘蘭 of the Ming Dynasty(1368-1644),Tao Chi'en 道濟, Shên Nan-ping 沈南蘋, and Chêng Pan-ch'iao鄭板橋 of the Ch'ing Dynasty(1644-1912).

Wên T'ung, a native of Szechuan, practiced penmanship for ten years but still failed to understand the secret of writing. One day this secret was suddenly revealed to him as he watched two snakes fighting by the wayside. His bamboo exhibits the dynamic quality of nature; the charm and motion in his pictures often convey to us strongly the wind blown effect.



Su Tung-P'o(1036-1101)learned his art from his friend, Wên T'ung, but on account of his different background in calligraphy he created a style of his own. His strokes have a dashing and sweeping quality, together with a restful mood, a fresh breath of life. He used a comparatively soft brush but with a very deft hand. He has a fine representation of ink values.

The Yüan Dynasty marked the zenith in ink bamboo painting on account of the widened scope of brush strokes and technical power brought into painting by its masters. Wu Chên(1280-1354),with his superior skill in "speed writing," crowned the glory of the Yüan Dynasty. The brush under the direction of his hand was transformed, as it were, into a sharp of its freedom. It was like a storm come suddenly with unlimited force, crushing everything in its way.

Ko Chiu-ssŭ, a great master of the Yüan Dynasty, was also a great scholar. He wrote a treatise on ink bamboo painting which was the second book published in this line in Chinese art history. He applied Li Shu 隸書 and K'ai Shu 楷書 technique in technique in painting bamboo, and his power, like that of Wu Chên, came from the sway of the whole arm instead of the wrist.

Fu Kuang, a monk originally of Shansi Province, studied the style of Wên T'ung, but in addition he brought forth the realistic texture of the bamboo and made the subject of his picture even more

intimate to his audience. But the real difference between the paintings of his teacher and those by himself is in the same category as the difference between Greek sculpture and that of Rome.

I cannot leave the Yüan Dynasty without mentioning Madame Chao Mêng-fu, still better known ad Madame Kuan Tao-shan [Kuan Chuang-chi].Being a woman she naturally paints more with feeling than knowledge, with a pure heart rather than with intellect. Her work is full of rhythm and beauty which should be felt rather than studied.

The Ming Dynasty (1368-1644) was generally known as the post-renaissance in Chinese art, and bamboo painting was no exception. The greatest Ming masters were Wang Fu (1362-1416)and Wên Chêng-ming. They brought back the Sung refinement to their brush. But the too reserves discipline of Ming masters under the influence of the Confucian idea of a law abiding society, made them somewhat timid and lacking in freedom in comparison with the masters of the previous Dynasties who drew their inspiration from Buddhism and Taoism. The brush of Wên Chêng-ming deserves the same criticism as the other masters of the Ming Dynasty. The exception is one girl artist who lived a different life and held to a philosophy different from all the others. She was highly gifted and well educated but unfortunately she led a Bohemian life and the sufferings experienced by herself and observed by others made her art sadly indignant to the world



without. Her strokes are charming and sweet but at the same time hold innate dignity.

Students of Chinese art are easily convinced that the polychromic landscapes of the Ch'ing Dynasty (1644-1912) are inferior to those of the Ming, but in the field of ink painting, especially in the paintings of bamboo, a certain technical beauty and freedom is revealed. The brush of Shên Nan-ping(f,1731)is at its best in ink paintings: the naturalism and charm of the bamboo are finely portrayed. His bamboo is a typical product of the technique of K'ai (regular) and Hsing (running) calligraphy.

Chêng Pan-ch'iao, also a poet and calligrapher, was the great romantic scholar of the Ch'ing Dynasty. Although he once accepted an official post in Shangtung, he was in his soul a Taoist and follower of the philosophy of Chuang Tzŭ.His bamboo retains a perfect, natural poise and freedom although he cannot free himself from formulas by which most Ming masters imprison themselves.

Those artists who resented or were indifferent to the rule of the Manchus became more attached to Buddhistic and Taoistic ideals. They thus strove for freedom, and freedom in art expression proved to be better and easier to attain than freedom of speech or writing. Ink bamboo offered them the best opportunity. Thus the brush of Tao Chien, better known as Monk Shih Tao 石濤和尚, was acclaimed the most powerful south of the Yangtse River.



Bamboo stems painted by his brush have a tactile feeling and three dimensional qualities.

From all these masterpieces we see the general tendency moving from the refinement and imagination of the Sung masters to the powerful calligraphic expressionism of the Yüan masters, and from the conservative copying of Sung refinement of the Ming to the charm and romantic freedom of the masters of the Ch'ing Dynasty.